

*How to approach a brand*

Getting the first yes

Every message below is written and ready. Swap in the highlighted parts and send. The templates are short on purpose — a brand manager reads the first two lines and decides. Everything after that only matters if those two lines worked.

SIX RULES THAT DECIDE WHETHER YOU GET A REPLY

1. **Lead with them, not you.** "I've been using your cleanser for three weeks" beats "I am a UGC creator with a passion for beauty." One proves you know them; the other could have been sent to anyone.
2. **Never open with your rate.** Price answers a question they have not asked yet. Get them interested first, quote second.
3. **One ask per message.** Not "let me know if you want UGC, live hosting, photography or a collab." Pick the one thing that fits them and ask for that.
4. **Say where you are.** Kota Bharu is an advantage, not an apology. Local brands want someone who can actually turn up; remote brands want someone whose rates are not KL rates.
5. **Show, do not describe.** One link to your work beats a paragraph about your style.
6. **Follow up once, then stop.** One nudge after five working days. If nothing, move on — and try again in three months when their campaign cycle turns over.

Send 10 a week, not 50 in one night. Ten researched messages beat fifty copy-pastes, and a burst of identical DMs is how accounts get flagged as spam. Ten a week is forty a month — at a normal reply rate that is a handful of real conversations, which is all you need.

WHAT TO ATTACH, AND WHEN

STAGE	SEND THIS
First message	Nothing attached. Just your website link. Attachments in a cold email get filtered to spam.
They replied and are interested	The service sheet for the one thing they asked about — a single page, not everything.
They asked "what are your rates?"	The rate card PDF, plus one line naming the likely package so they are not lost in nine pages.
A bigger brand or an agency	The business catalogue — 17 pages, for someone who has to justify you to a manager.
They said yes	The agreement summary , then the full booking agreement and invoice.

The cold email

Use for brands with a real marketing address, agencies, hotels, restaurants and anything with a website. Keep it under 150 words.

SUBJECT LINE — PICK ONE

UGC for **Brand** — Ara Aranya, Kota Bharu
Short-form video for **Brand**, in BM and English
Brand × Ara Aranya — a quick idea

THE EMAIL ITSELF

Hi **name**,

I'm Ara Aranya, a UGC creator and live host based in Kota Bharu, Kelantan. I make short-form video for brands — the kind that looks like a real person talking, not an advert.

I've been using **product** for **how long**, and I noticed **one specific, true observation — a gap in their content, a comment they keep getting, something a competitor does that they don't**.

I film, perform and edit everything myself, in Bahasa Melayu and English, and deliver in 3–5 days. My work is here: novabadzlinaglobal.com

Would it be useful if I sent over two concepts for **product**?

Ara Aranya
Nova Badzlina Global · Kota Bharu, Kelantan
+60 18-278 0523

The third paragraph is the whole email. Anyone can write the rest. Spend your five minutes finding one true, specific thing about their brand — that is what separates you from the fifty other creators in their inbox this week.

The one follow-up

Five working days later. Reply on your original email so the thread stays together.

FOLLOW-UP

Hi **name**, bringing this back up in case it got buried.

Still happy to put together a couple of concepts for **product** — no charge for the ideas, and no obligation.

If it's not the right time, just say and I'll check back after **month**.

Ara

By DM

TikTok, Instagram & WhatsApp

A DM is not a short email. Three lines maximum, no formatting, no attachments. If the first line does not land, nothing else gets read.

TikTok DM

ENGLISH

Hi! I'm Ara — UGC creator based in Kota Bharu 💜

I've been using **product** and I have an idea for a video that would suit your page. Made, filmed and edited by me, BM or English.

Want me to send the concept? No obligation 🌿

BAHASA MELAYU

Hai! Saya Ara — UGC creator dari Kota Bharu 💜

Saya guna **produk** dan ada satu idea video yang sesuai untuk page anda. Saya shoot dan edit sendiri, BM atau English.

Nak saya hantar konsepnya? Tiada obligasi 🌿

Instagram DM

Reply to a Story instead of opening a cold DM where you can — a Story reply lands in their main inbox, a cold DM often lands in Requests and is never seen.

ENGLISH

Hi **name**! Ara here — creator and live host from Kota Bharu.

Loved **the specific post or product**. I make short-form UGC for brands and I think **product** would work really well as **the specific format — a get-ready-with-me, a problem-solution hook, an unboxing**.

Portfolio: novabadzlinaglobal.com — would you like the concept?

WhatsApp — for local businesses

Cafes, salons, homestays and shops in Kelantan. Warmer register. Introduce yourself as a person before a service.

BAHASA MELAYU

Assalamualaikum / Hi **nama** 💜

Saya Ara Aranya, content creator dan photographer di Kota Bharu. Saya buat video pendek dan gambar untuk business — UGC, live host TikTok/Shopee, dan fotografi makanan.

Saya nampak **business anda** dan rasa gambar menu / video pendek boleh bantu tarik lebih ramai pelanggan.

Boleh saya hantar contoh kerja saya? Percuma untuk tengok dulu 🌿

Do not send the same DM twice on the same platform. If they do not reply, leave it. Following up in a DM reads as pressure in a way that an email follow-up does not — a DM arrives on their phone, personally.



Your profile, written out

LinkedIn is where agencies, brand managers and tourism boards look you up after they have met you elsewhere. It does not need to bring you traffic — it needs to make you look real when someone checks.

Headline — the line under your name

COPY THIS

UGC Creator & Live Host · Content Creation, Voice-Over & Photography | Nova Badzlina Global | Kota Bharu, Malaysia

About section

COPY THIS

I create short-form content that brands can actually use.

I'm Ara Aranya, the creator behind Nova Badzlina Global. I work across UGC, live commerce hosting on TikTok and Shopee, voice-over, product and food photography, and commercial talent work — in Bahasa Melayu and English.

Everything is written, filmed, performed and edited by me from my own home studio in Kota Bharu, Kelantan. That means fast turnaround, no agency mark-up, and a consistent voice across a whole campaign instead of five freelancers who have never spoken.

What I'm known for:

- Canvas UGC — I build a brand-new TikTok or Instagram account from zero, run it daily for 30 days, then hand the whole channel over.
- Live selling — TikTok Live and Shopee Live, in focused 30-minute slots.
- Two languages, one voice — BM and English, on camera and on mic.

I'm also an IT student and a solo mother. That isn't a footnote — it's why the work converts. When I film a Mom UGC piece, I'm not playing a role.

Rate card and portfolio: novabadzlinaglobal.com

Bookings: novabadzlinaglobal@gmail.com · +60 18-278 0523

Experience entry

COPY THIS

Founder & Creator — Nova Badzlina Global

Self-employed · Kota Bharu, Kelantan, Malaysia · **start month and year** – Present

Content production business serving brands in Malaysia and internationally. Services span UGC and short-form video, live commerce hosting, voice-over, product and food photography, photo editing, KOL/KOC campaigns, brand ambassadorship and commercial talent work.

- Produce ad-ready vertical video end to end — concept, script, filming, performance and edit
- Host live selling sessions on TikTok Live and Shopee Live

- Deliver in Bahasa Melayu and English for both local and international brands
- Operate written contracts, invoicing and usage licensing on every booking



Reaching out there

Connection request

Always add a note. A bare request from a stranger gets ignored. 300 characters maximum, so this is close to the limit.

COPY THIS

Hi **name** — I'm a UGC creator and live host based in Kota Bharu, working with beauty and lifestyle brands in BM and English. I follow what **company** is doing and would like to stay connected.

The message after they accept

Wait a day. Connecting and pitching in the same minute is transparent.

COPY THIS

Thanks for connecting, **name**.

I make short-form UGC and host live selling sessions for brands — everything filmed and edited in-house, in Bahasa Melayu and English, from Kota Bharu.

I had a look at **company**'s recent content and had one idea I think would work for **product or campaign**. Would it be useful if I sent it over? No obligation either way.

Portfolio and rate card: novabadzlinaglobal.com

WHERE TO FIND BRANDS WORTH APPROACHING

WHERE	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
TikTok Shop & Shopee	Sellers with good products but weak video. If their listing has only stills, they need you.
Instagram, local tags	#kotabharu #kelantanfood #kedaikelantan — small businesses with real customers and bad photos.
Your own purchases	Anything already in your house. You can honestly say you use it, which is the strongest opener there is.
New product launches	A brand launching something has budget allocated and a deadline. Both work in your favour.
Brands using other creators	If they already pay creators, they do not need convincing that UGC works — only that you are worth adding.

Keep a simple list. Brand, who you contacted, which platform, the date, and what happened. After a month you will see which platform actually replies to you — and then you can stop wasting evenings on the ones that do not.

When they reply

Talking about money

These are the replies that decide what you actually get paid. Having the words ready is the difference between holding your rate and agreeing to something at midnight you regret in the morning.

"What are your rates?"

ATTACH THE RATE CARD WITH THIS

Hi **name**, thanks for coming back to me.

My full rate card is attached. For what you've described, the closest fit is **package or line item — name it**, at **RM figure**.

That covers concept, script, filming, editing and captions, with organic usage included. Paid advertising usage is licensed separately, so tell me if you need it and I'll fold it into the quote.

Happy to put a firm number in writing once I know the deliverables and the deadline.

Ara

Always name one line from the card. Sending nine pages and letting them guess is how a quote turns into a negotiation. Point at the number you want.

"We only do barter / gifting"

COPY THIS

Thanks for coming back to me.

I do take gifted collaborations occasionally, but only where I approached the brand — because then the product was my choice and the risk is mine.

For briefs that come from a brand, the content is paid work: you choose the product, set the price and hold the stock, and none of those are things I control.

My single video starts at RM 400, and gifted product can come off that. If the budget genuinely isn't there this quarter, tell me when it is and I'll keep the door open.

Ara

When they reply

Holding your ground

"Can you do it cheaper?"

COPY THIS

I can work to most budgets — but by changing the scope, not the rate.

For **their budget** I could do **a smaller deliverable — one video instead of three, 30 seconds instead of 60, organic usage only instead of paid**.

Which matters more to you: the number of videos, or the usage rights? Tell me and I'll shape it around that.

Never just lower the number. The moment you discount without removing something, your rate card becomes a suggestion — and that brand will open at the discount every time after. Cut scope, hold price.

"Send us your portfolio"

COPY THIS

Of course — everything is here: novabadzlinaglobal.com

The Work page has my video and photography, and there's a voice demo page if audio is relevant. I've attached my rate card too so you have the numbers in front of you.

If you tell me the product and roughly when you'd need it, I'll come back with a firm quote rather than a range.

They said yes, then went quiet

COPY THIS

Hi **name** — just checking in on **project**.

I have **date** held for you at the moment. If the timeline has moved, no problem at all — just let me know so I can open the slot up.

Ara

That last one does real work. It is polite, it is not needy, and it quietly tells them the date is worth something. Most silences are internal delays rather than rejections — but the slot is still yours to lose.